1. Established in the mid-1920s by the Comintern – the Soviet-controlled organisation that governed Communist parties around the globe.

2. Typed transcript of 1983 Ogonjok interview, Honecker papers. German State Archives.

3. Honecker, Erich. From My Life . Pergamon, 1981. p.45

4. Ibid.

5. Norbert Pötzl ‘Honecker: Eine deutsche Biographie’ Deutsche VerlagsAnstalt GmbH, 2002. p.28

6. Saarbrucker Zeitung. 5 May 1971

7. Born in 1886, ‘Teddy’ Thalmann a longshoreman and transport worker, joined the KPD in 1920 and became its party chairman in Hamburg in l921.

8. From My Life . p.61

9. Ibid p.70

10. Ibid p.91

11. Ibid

12. Ibid

13. Heinz Lippmann’s Honecker and the New Politics of Europe . Macmillan, 1972. p.245

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1. Honecker Cross Examined . p.88